

Outlook

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Sent	Tue, 19 Jul 2022 11:34:00 -0000

Follow-up: can we distinguish a cyber event from a payments outage?

Hi,

This came up in a working session and nobody had the same definition.

Timeouts, host-response failures and repeated attempts can resemble malicious activity or ordinary service degradation.

I do not want a dashboard that simply counts the outcome. Start with the competing explanations: technical failure explains the cluster; operational retries are obscuring the original event; or a concentrated account or terminal pattern suggests abuse.

The timing also overlaps with Record Stage 6 load shedding across major metros. Treat that as context to test, not an answer. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause. This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use July 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion.

What we need to decide is the minimum evidence needed to route an alert to Cyber, Fraud, Payments or Infrastructure. Please bring a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list, including a few cases we can trace from source to conclusion.

The available evidence is transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency. This is triage design from available telemetry, not a substitute for SOC, firewall or application logs.

Thank you